



FIREWATCH

When wildfire strikes, do you know what to do?

Real-time wildfire situational awareness for Nova Scotia communities

THE MOMENT THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING

May 28, 2023

Hammonds Plains, Nova Scotia.

16,000

residents evacuated

30 min

average notice given

950 ha

burned in 24 hours

Residents received a wall of text on their phones. No one knew if the fire was heading toward their street. No one knew which road to take. No one knew how long they had.

THE PROBLEM

Nova Scotia had no community-specific wildfire tool for residents.

What existed before

- Generic province-wide alerts
- Built for forestry professionals
- Updated once per day
- No evacuation guidance
- No community-level view

What residents actually need

- Is the fire near MY community?
- How long do I have?
- Which road do I take?
- Where do I go?
- Who is responding?

THE SOLUTION

Firewatch

Community-level wildfire situational awareness.

Open the app. Know what to do. In 5 seconds.



Live Data

Real-time weather pulled every session
— temperature, humidity, wind speed &
direction, precipitation



Risk Score

Four variables combined into a 0–100
community risk score across 26 NS
communities



Action

Evacuation route, nearest shelter, drive
time, emergency contacts — front and
centre

Everything a resident needs — in one screen.



Interactive Map

26 NS communities colour-coded by risk level. Low risk fades back. Danger zones glow.



Risk Score 0–100

Temperature + humidity + wind + precipitation = one clear danger number per community.



7-Day Risk Outlook

Scrub through the week to see how conditions evolve. Plan before the fire starts.



Evacuation Guidance

Specific route, nearest shelter, and estimated drive time — per community, always visible.



Live Wind Direction

Wind drives fire spread. A live indicator shows which way danger is moving across NS.



Status Banner

All Clear / Watch Conditions / Critical — province-wide status visible the moment you open the app.

IMPACT

The numbers that matter.

26

NS communities
monitored live

0

existing public
community tools

5 sec

to know your
evacuation route

7 days

of risk outlook
per community

"Firewatch doesn't replace 911 — it gives every Nova Scotian the 5 minutes of clarity that could save their life."



FIREWATCH

Nova Scotia Wildfire Watch

Built for Hack the Elements 2026 · ShiftKey Labs

When seconds matter — clarity saves lives.